

Why Did I Not Get Into PBK?

Math and science majors with very high GPAs sometimes are not elected into Phi Beta Kappa, the national honor society. Selection considers a student's broader liberal arts education as well as academic achievement. Individual chapters determine their selection processes using national minimum criteria.

Consult the [current Phi Beta Kappa membership stipulations](#). The national stipulations were updated on June 18, 2025.

Language study

Stipulation 2 states: "Candidates shall demonstrate knowledge of a second or non-native language at a college level."

At UVA, the College's Phi Beta Kappa criteria also expect at least one intermediate foreign-language course (2020 level or higher) taken in residence at UVA, and at least one course in mathematics, logic, or statistics; see [College awards and honors](#). This may influence the courses you select.

This page updates the department's guidance originally dated February 11, 2016. The older document referred to language study as Stipulation 3; students should use the current national stipulations when planning their courses.